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Section: IT703P

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Activity 5: Computer Startup Problems Research

Objective:

Identify common problems that may occur during the computer boot process and determine their possible causes and solutions.

Instructions:

Research online for common problems encountered when turning on a computer. Find at least 5 different problems. Then create a table and must provide and answer the following:

1. Problem Encountered
2. Possible Cause
3. Boot Process Stage Involved
4. Possible Solution

Problem Encountered	Possible Cause	Boot Process Stage Involved	Possible Solution
No Boot Device Found	Hard drive/SSD is not detected, disconnected, or damaged	BIOS/UEFI (Pre-Boot Stage)	Check drive connections, verify boot order in BIOS, or replace the faulty drive.
Operating System Not Found	Corrupted boot files or incorrect boot configuration	Windows Boot Manager	Repair boot files using Startup Repair or reinstall the operating system.
BOOTMGR Is Missing	Missing or damaged Windows Boot Manager file	Windows Boot Manager	Boot from a Windows installation media and run Startup Repair.

Blue Screen of Death (BSOD) During Startup	Faulty drivers, hardware failure, or corrupted system files	Kernel Loading Stage	Boot into Safe Mode, update drivers, and run system diagnostics.
Black Screen with Blinking Cursor	Computer cannot find a bootable operating system	Boot Loader Stage	Check boot settings, repair boot records, and ensure the correct drive is selected.

Guide Questions:

After completing the table, answer:

1. Which startup problem did you find most difficult to diagnose? Why?

The Blue Screen of Death (BSOD) is the most difficult to diagnose because it can have many different causes.

2. Which boot process stage is associated with the most problems you found?

The Windows Boot Manager stage is associated with the most problems.

3. What problem would prevent the computer from reaching the operating system?

The No Boot Device Found error would prevent the computer from reaching the operating system.

4. What problem would occur after the operating system has already started loading?

A Blue Screen of Death (BSOD) can occur after the operating system starts loading.

5. Why is understanding the boot process important when troubleshooting a computer?

Understanding the boot process helps identify where the problem occurs and how to fix it.